

DELHI | Upgradation Turbulence



HINDON AIRBASE

REUTERS

The Indian Air Force's (IAF) critical project for modernising 30 vital defence airfields remains grounded. Unhappy about losing out on the \$260-million deal, the Italian firm that was beaten to the contract by Tata Power has filed a case against the Ministry of Defence (MOD). It is now the largest con-

tract won by an Indian firm in open bidding. Italian firm Selex Sistemi Integrati has charged the MOD with violating procurement procedures. Tata Power will now upgrade landing and navigation facilities at 30 airfields, 16 along the China border. This is part of the IAF's move to beef up vigilance on the frontier and facilitate the induction of force multipliers like the Phalcon AWACS and C-130J transport aircraft. The

36-month contract included improving complete airfield infrastructure like instrument landing and communication systems. Hindon airbase near Delhi was to be the first to be upgraded in nine months as a turnkey project. It now seems unlikely that the airfields will be ready in time.

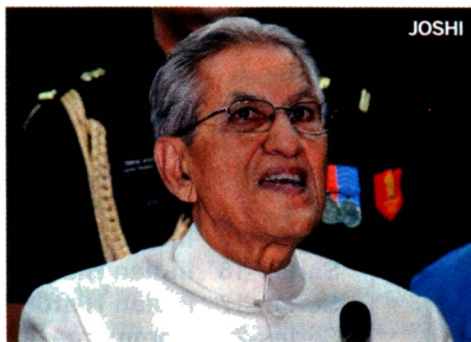
by Sandeep Unnithan

Game Plan

The sports ministry's annual recognition procedure made mandatory for sports federations is a phase of its guerilla war against crooked officials. Getting the "feds" to fall in line with election procedures and accountability will now follow.

LUCKNOW | Uncommon Style

Uttar Pradesh Governor B.L. Joshi is bringing in changes, and not just in Raj Bhavan. He's also doing away with the VIP culture. Unlike his predecessor T.V. Rajeshwar—who the Opposition called a "dictator"—Joshi has made himself accessible to everyone and has done away with the frisking of visitors. Another surprise for Lucknow residents is that Joshi ensures that there are no traffic curbs when his motorcade drives around the city. He says that being a governor, a chief minister or a prime minister "is just like a role given to individuals for the time being to play." After that, according to Joshi, one becomes a commoner, "so one should be-



SANJAY SONKAR

have and live like a common man". While Rajeshwar was at loggerheads with Mulayam Singh Yadav, Joshi has also struck a healthy working equilibrium with Mayawati.

by Subhash Mishra

MUMBAI | Child Rights

Adopting Indian children may become slightly more expensive for foreigners. It will, however, ensure the financial and emotional safety of the Indian child in case anything goes wrong. Prospective parents coming to India to adopt a child may now have to deposit \$500 (Rs 25,000) over the standard adoption fee of \$3,500 (Rs 1.75 lakh). This suggestion was made by an expert committee set up by the Bombay High Court. A foreign adoption matter in the court involved a girl who was adopted by a US citizen but sent back to India in 2008 after developing behavioural problems. The Central Adoption and Resource Authority (CARA) has accepted the recommendations of the court committee and will set up a National Adoption and Rehabilitation Fund for disruptive or repatriated adoption cases in inter-country adoptions. J.K. Mittal, chairman, CARA, said that if the court orders the setting up of a special fund, "it will be of great benefit to repatriated children as they will have something to fall back on".

by Harsha Bhat